

Also, you need to stop researching at some point and start writing. Otherwise, you'll never complete your essay or research paper. So once you have summarised all your findings, it is time to start writing. When do you know it's time to stop researching? There is no hard and fast rule, but you shouldn't spend more than 30 minutes per page of the final work in general. So, if your final paper or essay is meant to be 15 pages long, you shouldn't spend more than 7.5 hours researching it.

6. Perform additional research

You'll most likely discover a few holes once you've begun writing the first draft of your paper. Perhaps you realise that one scholar's point of view is irrelevant to your article, or that you require additional material for a specific area. You are free to return to your research as needed in this scenario.

But, once again, be wary of the productivity trap of procrastination! Only conduct extra research as necessary to address your question. Avoid falling into rabbit holes or going off on tangents. Get down to business, conduct your research, and resume writing. To stay focused, keep a separate document or piece of paper nearby to jot down issues that require more investigation. Make a note of it in the document every time you come across one, and then keep writing. Only come to a halt when you can't go any farther without more research.

It's far preferable to finish a whole draft first. Otherwise, you risk incurring a cognitive switching penalty, which will make it more difficult to regain attention.

7. Credit all sources

You'll need to cite your sources whether you're doing an oral presentation, an essay, or a video. Plagiarism is a serious infraction, so don't chance it.

The style in which you credit your sources is determined by the subject and the expectations of your tutor. The most prevalent citation forms in college are Chicago, MLA, and APA, although there are many more. The following image shows the MLA style of citations.

Fortunately, you won't have to enter each of your citations by hand or wade through a style guide. Instead, track and generate your citations with a tool like Zotero. Install the Zotero Connector browser extension to make things easier. It can pull citation information from entries in an online library catalogue automatically.